

Nakawa University Academic Handbook 2025/2026

version: 2025/2026 Edition | effective: 2025-08-01 | owner: Office of the Academic Registrar

SECTION 1. Purpose and Scope

This Handbook sets out the academic rules that apply to all undergraduate students of Nakawa University for the 2025/2026 academic year. Where this Handbook conflicts with a Programme Handbook, this Handbook prevails on matters of general academic regulation. Where it conflicts with the Examination Regulations on matters of assessment conduct, the Examination Regulations prevail.

All students are deemed to have read this Handbook upon registration. Ignorance of a rule contained in this Handbook is not accepted as grounds for appeal.

SECTION 2. Registration

Every student must register at the beginning of each semester. Registration consists of three steps which must all be completed:

- 1 Payment of at least sixty per cent (60%) of the semester tuition.
- 2 Online course selection through the Student Portal.
- 3 Biometric confirmation at the Faculty Registrar's office.

A student who has not completed all three steps by the close of the registration period is not a registered student for that semester. Unregistered students may not attend classes, access the Learning Management System, or sit any assessment.

The registration period opens on the first day of the semester and closes at the end of the third week of teaching. Late registration is permitted during the fourth week only, on payment of a late registration fee of UGX 50,000.

SECTION 3. Course Add and Drop

A registered student may add or drop courses during the add/drop period, subject to the limits in this section.

The add/drop period for Semester I of 2025/2026 closes on Friday 26 September 2025 at 17:00 East Africa Time. The add/drop period for Semester II closes on Friday 13 February 2026 at 17:00 East Africa Time.

Adding or dropping is performed by the student on the Student Portal and must then be approved by the Head of Department. A change that is not approved by the Head of Department before the deadline is void, and the student remains registered for the original course set.

The following limits apply during add/drop:

- A student may not exceed the maximum semester load of 24 credit units, nor fall below the minimum full-time load of 15 credit units.
- A student may not add a course whose teaching has already exceeded three sessions.
- A student may not drop a core course required by their programme. Only elective courses may be dropped.
- A course dropped within the add/drop period does not appear on the academic transcript and attracts no financial penalty.

After the add/drop deadline the student is academically and financially committed to the registered course set. A course abandoned after the deadline is graded as F (Fail) and counts in the cumulative grade point average.

SECTION 4. Withdrawal from a Course

Withdrawal is distinct from dropping. Withdrawal applies after the add/drop deadline has passed and requires documented grounds.

A student may apply to withdraw from a course up to the end of the ninth week of teaching. The application is made on Form AR/7, is supported by documentary evidence, and is decided by the Faculty Board. Acceptable grounds are limited to:

- Documented illness or injury, supported by a report from University Health Services or a recognised medical practitioner.
- Bereavement of an immediate family member.
- A documented timetable clash created by an administrative error of the University.

A course from which a student has withdrawn with approval is recorded on the transcript with the code W. A grade of W carries no grade points and does not affect the cumulative grade point average, but the credit units still count toward the maximum permitted programme duration.

An application to withdraw after the ninth week is not considered except under the Exceptional Circumstances procedure in Section 9.

SECTION 5. Attendance

A student must attend at least seventy-five per cent (75%) of the scheduled sessions of a course to be eligible to sit the final examination for that course. Attendance is recorded by the course lecturer and published on the Student Portal by the end of the eleventh week.

A student whose attendance falls below 75% is issued a Missing Attendance Notice and has five working days to submit an explanation to the Head of Department. Where the explanation is not accepted, the student is barred from the final examination and is graded F for that course.

SECTION 6. Grading Scheme

Nakawa University uses a five-point grading scheme. Marks are reported as whole numbers out of 100.

Mark range	Letter grade	Grade point	Interpretation	
------------	--------------	-------------	----------------	--

--- --- --- ---				
-----------------	--	--	--	--

80 – 100	A	5.0	Excellent	
----------	---	-----	-----------	--

70 – 79	B	4.0	Very good	
---------	---	-----	-----------	--

60 – 69	C	3.0	Good	
---------	---	-----	------	--

50 – 59	D	2.0	Pass	
---------	---	-----	------	--

0 – 49	F	0.0	Fail	
--------	---	-----	------	--

The minimum pass mark for any undergraduate course is 50. The cumulative grade point average is computed across all attempted courses, weighted by credit units, and is reported to two decimal places.

SECTION 7. Retakes and Progression

A student who is graded F in a course must retake that course. A retake is taken the next time the course is offered and attracts a retake fee equal to the per-credit-unit tuition rate for the course.

The mark recorded for a successful retake is capped at 50, that is, the minimum pass mark, regardless of the raw mark obtained. The capped mark replaces the failed mark in the computation of the cumulative grade point average, but the original attempt remains visible on the internal academic record.

A student may retake a given course a maximum of three times. A student who fails the same course a fourth time is discontinued from the programme.

A student must accumulate at least 45 credit units in an academic year to progress to the next year of study. A student who accumulates fewer than 45 credit units repeats the year.

SECTION 8. Deferment of Study

A student may apply to defer study for a full semester or a full academic year. Deferment is not granted for part of a semester.

The application is made on Form AR/11 not later than the end of the fourth week of the semester concerned, and is approved by the Academic Registrar. A deferring student pays a deferment maintenance fee of UGX 100,000 per semester deferred and retains their student number and programme place.

The maximum cumulative deferment permitted over the course of an undergraduate programme is two semesters.

SECTION 9. Exceptional Circumstances

Where a student's academic performance or ability to meet a deadline has been materially affected by circumstances beyond their control, the student may submit an Exceptional Circumstances application to the Faculty Board.

The application must be submitted within ten working days of the circumstance arising, or within ten working days of the affected assessment, whichever is later. It must be accompanied by independent documentary evidence. Self-certification is not accepted for any application relating to a final examination.

The Faculty Board may, where the application is upheld, grant one of the following remedies: an extension of a submission deadline, a further attempt at an assessment as a first attempt, withdrawal from a course outside the normal deadline, or retrospective deferment.

The Faculty Board does not have authority to alter a mark awarded by an examiner.

SECTION 10. Maximum Programme Duration

An undergraduate programme of three years must be completed within five years of first registration. An undergraduate programme of four years must be completed within six years of first registration. Periods of approved deferment are included in this count. A student who exceeds the maximum duration is discontinued.